PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

May 27, 2026
Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center, 501 N. Dixon Street, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Member: Virginia La Forte - Committee Chair

Other Attendees: Candice Grose - Chief of Communications; Tom Odgers - Chief of Operations; Sarah Norman - Senior Legal Counsel, RISE; Liz Large - Contracted Senior Legal Counsel Diallo Lewis - Assistant District Athletic Director ; Joanna Evenson - Senior Director, RISE/Consolidated and Facilities Construction Projects; Paul Williams - Senior Financial Ops. Manager; TJ Hopkins - Senior Director of RISE/Modernizations; Rosanne Powell - Senior Board Operations Manager; Deborah Kafoury-Chief of Staff; Emily Courtnage - Senior Legal Counsel

Director La Forte called the meeting to order at 4:34 pm.

Public Comment

- Lisa Jackson - expressed concerns regarding the lack of a dedicated space for Indian Education in the Jefferson High School modernization project.

Overview: Pool RFP Process

Paul Williams shared that this practice is not a new process for the District, but is not commonly used. This will allow for more efficiency for the volume of contracts required to do the same category of work. There was discussion about the ability to do competitive pricing with this process given the constraints of Oregon laws. It was confirmed that vendors submit their pricing matrix with the Request for Proposal (RFP). Staff explained that pricing information is obtained during solicitation and project assignment phases and that assignments are made using a workload and qualifications-based matrix intended to support delivery of multiple projects across the bond program.

Timeline for Athletic Facility Master Planning Process

Committee members discussed future considerations for the Grant Bowl, including controlled access and fencing to support athletic event operations. Staff noted that fencing is not required by OSAA but may support event management and ticketed contests.
Staff reported that ongoing lease negotiations with Portland Parks & Recreation have created schedule risk for projects. There was discussion about communications with Portland Parks and Recreation (PP&R).

Athletics Swing Site Plan

Staff provided an update on the swing site plans for high schools under construction and confirmed that the middle school sports programs will use the swing sites for their feeder high schools. Jefferson athletics remain largely on-site during construction, Cleveland athletics will relocate to Marshall, and Ida B. Wells programs will share Jackson facilities through staggered scheduling.

Update on the implementation of the Bond Audit Recommendations

Sarah Norman shared updates on the recommendations from the Bond Audit, noting that Year 2, Recommendation # 10 is closed. Year 4, Recommendation #5 was reopened by the external bond auditor in April which the RISE team is reviewing, and the Year 6, Recommendation #13 was reopened by the external bond auditor, and staff is working to provide the information they requested.

Review revisions to the Bond Accountability Committee Charter

Greg DiLoreto, the Bond Accountability Committee (BAC) Chair, commented that the BAC had reviewed the proposed charter revisions and had recommended it be sent to the Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee for review. Discussion included whether the BAC should receive copies of program-level and project-specific Program Management Plans containing key performance indicators. Staff indicated they would confirm that BAC members have access to those materials There were questions regarding KPIs referenced in the Committee Charge section, and whether bond expenditure testing should be included in the district's financial audit process. Director La Forte stated the BAC Charter would go to the Board for approval at the June 9th meeting.

Adjourn

Chair LaForte adjourned the meeting at 5:36 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell

Senior Board Manager / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools
